

Orbio Evidence Appendix

Gift #13 | Public competitive evidence | Checked 2 Sep 2026

This appendix supports the Executive Brief. It is not a full market map. The scope is limited to the two locked findings and the three competitors selected for the brief: Workday Paradox, Fountain and UKG.

1. Claim legend

Label	Meaning
FACT	Directly supported by cited public evidence.
INFERENCE	Reasoned interpretation from verified facts. Not presented as a proven internal state.
NOT ESTABLISHED	Searched or considered, but not proven by the public evidence reviewed.

2. Final findings

Finding 1 - Orbio's structural relationship with Workday is now competitively ambiguous.

FACT: Orbio publicly lists Workday as an integration. FACT: Workday signed a definitive agreement to acquire Paradox on 21 Aug 2025 and completed the acquisition on 1 Oct 2025. FACT: Workday markets the resulting product as Workday Paradox Candidate Experience Agent. FACT: Workday's Paradox materials focus on candidate experience, instant responses, self-scheduling, interview coordination and high-volume/frontline hiring. INFERENCE: María now overlaps with a Workday-owned product at the hiring edge while Orbio also integrates with Workday as part of a customer stack.

Decision question: How should Orbio position María when a platform it integrates with also owns a competing product at that edge of the lifecycle?

Guardrail: The evidence does not establish a formal partnership, co-sell relationship, channel relationship or Workday-led distribution for Orbio.

Finding 2 - Orbio's original 'first AI-native' full-lifecycle positioning now sits in a much denser competitive field.

FACT: In Sep 2025, Orbio was described as the 'first AI-native' HCM system and its CEO used first-AI-native language in a funding announcement that also framed the product around the employee lifecycle. FACT: Orbio's current homepage presents an AI HR system for enterprise and large workforces and describes agents working end-to-end from job post to retention insights, but does not use the word 'first'. FACT: Fountain presents an agentic platform spanning hiring, onboarding and support workflows; Anna screens high-volume frontline applicants. FACT: UKG Rapid Hire covers high-volume hiring, screening, scheduling, onboarding and first-day readiness, while UKG separately presents agentic frontline workforce operations. INFERENCE: Full-lifecycle AI is no longer a clean uniqueness boundary on its own.

Decision question: If full-lifecycle AI is no longer a unique architecture, what should become the defensible center of Orbio's positioning?

Guardrail: The reason for Orbio's homepage wording change is not established. The brief does not claim Orbio changed wording because of competitors.

3. Source register

ID	Source	Class	Location/date	Use
S1	Orbio homepage	Company / primary	orbio.work	Current positioning, agents, Workday integration, compliance claims
S2	EU-Startups: Orbio seed round	Press-derived / media	eu-startups.com, 25 Sep 2025	Original 'first AI-native' and launch-to-scale context; 60,000+ interviews
S3	TechCrunch: Orbio Series A	Independent media	techcrunch.com, 14 Jun 2026	Public competitor framing; \$21M Series A; scope of Orbio
S4	Workday signs definitive agreement to acquire Paradox	Company / primary	newsroom.workday.com, 21 Aug 2025	Paradox scope, frontline/high-volume candidate experience, intent to acquire
S5	Workday completes acquisition of Paradox	Company / primary	newsroom.workday.com, 1 Oct 2025	Workday Paradox Candidate Experience Agent available for purchase
S6	Fountain homepage	Company / primary	fountain.com	Cue, Anna, Emma, Sam; hiring/onboarding/support workflow coverage
S7	Fountain AI Recruiter on ADP Marketplace	Marketplace / partner listing	apps.adp.com	Anna as standalone AI screening agent for high-volume frontline hiring
S8	UKG Rapid Hire product page	Company / primary	ukg.com	High-volume hiring, screening, scheduling, onboarding, first-day readiness
S9	BusinessWire: UKG agentic AI recognition	Company-distributed news	businesswire.com, 13 May 2026	UKG Rapid Hire, Shiftboard, analyst quote reported via UKG
S10	UKG newsroom scale reference	Company / primary	ukg.co.uk, 13 May 2026	80,000+ organizations across 150 countries
S11	Workday/UKG implementation timelines	Independent implementation consultants / review sources	various	Used only as context; not like-for-like with Orbio
S12	Orbio deployment-time search	Negative evidence note	public web search	No public per-customer implementation timeline found

4. Evidence map

Dimension	Workday Paradox	Fountain	UKG
Exact overlap	Candidate experience: application flow, instant responses, self-scheduling, interview coordination. Overlaps with María.	Hiring plus onboarding plus support workflows. Anna screens high-volume frontline applicants. Overlaps with María/Daniel/Claire directionally.	Rapid Hire covers hiring, scheduling, onboarding and first-day readiness; Dynamic Workforce Operations adds frontline operations. Overlaps with Orbio and extends beyond it.
Non-overlap / open point	Current public scope is strongest at hiring/candidate experience. Post-hire retention is not established from the reviewed sources.	Depth of daily check-ins/performance monitoring equivalent to Claire is not fully established publicly.	No clear Orbio-only coverage gap found from public sources. Orbio's possible wedge is more likely adoption path, focus or configuration, not coverage.
Ownership	Paradox signed acquisition agreement with Workday in Aug 2025; deal completed Oct 2025.	Independent company, OnboardIQ Inc. dba Fountain.	Large incumbent formed from Ultimate Software and Kronos.
Scale	Workday platform scale: 11,000+ organizations and 65%+ of Fortune 500 are cited in Workday materials; Paradox deployment within that base is not established.	30M+ annual applications and named customers reported in company/market sources; use as scale signal, not audited metric.	80,000+ organizations across 150 countries per UKG newsroom.
Implication	A product edge that looked startup-vs-startup now sits inside a platform Orbio integrates with.	Closest architecture-to-architecture peer found in this review.	Shows lifecycle agentic workflows are now a large-platform priority, not only a startup feature race.

5. Workday / Paradox evidence

Claim	Status	Evidence
Workday signed definitive agreement to acquire Paradox on 21 Aug 2025.	FACT	S4
Workday completed the acquisition on 1 Oct 2025.	FACT	S5
Workday Paradox Candidate Experience Agent is available for purchase through Workday or Paradox.	FACT	S5
Paradox focuses on candidate experience, instant responses, self-scheduling and 24/7 conversational support.	FACT	S4
Orbio lists Workday as an integration.	FACT	S1
Orbio's María and Workday Paradox overlap at the hiring/candidate-experience edge.	INFERENCE	S1, S4, S5

Wording lock: use 'integration' only. Do not write partner, channel, distribution partner or co-sell unless a direct source proves it.

6. Fountain evidence

Claim	Status	Evidence
Fountain presents agents running hiring, onboarding and support workflows end to end.	FACT	S6
Cue is positioned as the orchestrator; Anna, Emma and Sam are listed as agents.	FACT	S6
Anna is a standalone AI screening agent for high-volume frontline hiring and conducts structured conversational interviews.	FACT	S7
Fountain is the closest architecture-to-architecture peer found in this review.	INFERENCE	S1, S6, S7

7. UKG evidence

Claim	Status	Evidence
UKG Rapid Hire is designed for high-volume frontline hiring.	FACT	S8
UKG says Rapid Hire automates up to 90% of repetitive hiring tasks including sourcing, screening, scheduling, onboarding and first-day readiness.	FACT	S8
BusinessWire/UKG coverage describes Rapid Hire as AI-native high-volume hiring and reports recognition for frontline workforce operations with agentic AI.	FACT with source-class caveat	S9
UKG serves more than 80,000 organizations across 150 countries.	FACT	S10
UKG's evidence shows lifecycle workforce AI is being pursued at incumbent-platform scale.	INFERENCE	S8-S10

8. Potential wedge and not-established item

CONFIRMED: Orbio reported fast early enterprise adoption at company level: within three to four months of launch, it had processed 60,000+ candidate interviews for named employers. This is relevant because it suggests early pull and enterprise usability.

NOT ESTABLISHED: Orbio's per-customer implementation time. Public evidence did not provide a customer case study, rollout timeline or implementation-time claim that would allow a like-for-like comparison against Workday or UKG implementation timelines.

INFERENCE: Time-to-value may be a defensible wedge if Orbio can prove a lighter adoption path than full HCM-suite deployments. The current public evidence supports this only as a potential wedge, not a verified one.

9. Dropped or constrained items

Item	Decision	Reason
WorkJam	Dropped	Overlap appeared strongest post-hire and less complete than Fountain/UKG. It did not add enough to the final two-finding brief.
CEO personally framed Paradox as independent	Not used	The Paradox/WorkJam competitor list in TechCrunch appears to be reporter text, not a direct CEO quote.
Media pattern claim	Constrained	Multiple outlets repeated similar wording, but this appears derivative of one source rather than independent analysis.
Workday as partner/channel	Not used	Only integration is established.
Orbio implementation speed vs Workday/UKG	Not established	Company-level launch-to-scale metric is not the same as per-customer implementation time.

10. Method and QA notes

- Research was limited to public sources. No private Orbio, Workday, Fountain or UKG data was used.
- The competitor set was capped at three in the final deliverable: Workday Paradox, Fountain and UKG.
- Vendor claims were kept as vendor claims unless independently supported.
- Negative findings were not converted into claims. Missing public implementation-time evidence is marked NOT ESTABLISHED.
- The deck uses decision questions rather than asserting that Orbio's strategy is wrong. The brief identifies competitive pressure and positioning choices that may deserve internal testing.